launchpointgrowth

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Finance and Expense Management

Financial controls, approval processes and reporting responsibilities that protect the business while it grows.

DOCUMENT NO.	VERSION	EFFECTIVE DATE	CLASSIFICATION
LPG-FIN-SOP-001	1.0	19 October 2026	Internal – Confidential

DOCUMENT CONTROL

About this document

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) sets out the financial controls, approval processes and reporting responsibilities that apply across LaunchPoint Growth. It is written to support the company's Sales and Marketing Plan: the plan sets how we attract customers and grow revenue, and this SOP makes sure the money that funds and results from that growth is authorised, recorded, protected and reported correctly.

Field	Detail
Document title	Finance and Expense Management SOP
Document number	LPG-FIN-SOP-001
Version	1.0
Effective date	19 October 2026
Next scheduled review	19 October 2027, or sooner if the business, its systems or applicable law change
Document owner	Director (Strategy and Growth), supported by the Finance Officer
Applies to	All directors, employees, interns, contractors and consultants who spend, approve, record or report company money
Base currency	Pakistani Rupee (PKR). Foreign-currency items are converted at the bank rate on the transaction date.
Related documents	Sales and Marketing Plan; client service agreements; Annual Budget; Code of Conduct

Note on monetary thresholds

The PKR limits in this SOP are recommended starting values for an early-stage consultancy. The Directors should confirm or adjust them before adoption, and again at each annual review as revenue and headcount grow. Tax and statutory references should be confirmed with the company's tax advisor.

Approval and sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Director (Strategy and Growth)			
Director (Marketing and Operations)			
Finance Officer			

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
1.0	19 Oct 2026	Directors	Initial release of the SOP.

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How to use this SOP

Sections 1–4 explain who is responsible for what and who may approve what. Sections 5–12 describe the day-to-day procedures for budgets, expenses, purchases, petty cash, vendors, customers, records and reporting. Sections 13–16 cover monthly review, fraud prevention, conflicts of interest and exceptions. The appendices contain ready-to-use forms and checklists.

SECTION 01

Purpose, Scope and Principles

1.1 Purpose

LaunchPoint Growth helps startups find customers, sharpen their message and turn marketing into measurable growth. We are asking clients to trust us with their growth budgets, so we must show the same discipline with our own. This SOP establishes the basic financial controls that:

- ensure every rupee spent is **approved before it is committed**, for a business purpose, and within budget;
- protect company funds, bank accounts, advertising accounts and client money from loss, error and fraud;
- produce **accurate, timely financial records** so the Directors can make decisions on real numbers;
- link spending to the results in the Sales and Marketing Plan, such as leads, conversion rate, revenue and marketing return on investment (ROI);
- keep the company compliant with applicable tax, regulatory and contractual obligations.

1.2 Scope

This SOP applies to all company financial activity, including:

- budget preparation, monitoring and re-forecasting;
- expense claims, purchase requests, petty cash and corporate card or digital ad-platform spending;
- vendor onboarding, invoice processing and payments, including payroll and contractor payments;
- customer invoicing, collections and refunds or credit notes;
- bookkeeping, record retention, month-end close, reconciliations and management reporting;
- fraud prevention, conflicts of interest and access to financial systems.

It applies to everyone who handles company money or information, regardless of seniority. Where a client's money is handled on its behalf (for example, an advertising budget funded by a client), the client's agreement and Section 7.5 apply in addition to this SOP.

1.3 Guiding principles

Principle	What it means in practice
Approve before you commit	No order, contract or payment is made until the right person has approved it in writing. Approving after the fact is an exception that must be reported.
Separate the duties	No single person should be able to request, approve, pay and record the same transaction. Where the team is too small to separate fully, a Director review is the compensating control.
Keep evidence	Every transaction has a supporting document: quote, request, invoice, receipt or agreement. No document, no payment.
Spend within budget	Spending is checked against an approved budget line. Overruns need approval *before* they happen.
Be transparent	Financial information is accurate, shared with the people who need it, and never adjusted to look better than reality.
Speak up	Anyone can raise a concern about financial conduct without fear of retaliation (Section 14).

SECTION 02

Roles and Responsibilities

LaunchPoint Growth is a small team, so some roles are held by the same person or provided by an outsourced accountant. What matters is that the *responsibilities* below are clearly assigned and that no one reviews their own work.

Role	Key financial responsibilities
Directors (Strategy and Growth; Marketing and Operations)	Own this SOP and the Annual Budget. Approve spending above delegated limits, authorise payments, sign off monthly financial statements, review exceptions, and set the tone for ethical conduct. Directors may not approve their own expenses; the other Director does.
Strategy Lead (Budget Owner)	Owns budget lines for strategy services, research tools and training. Approves expenses and purchase requests within limits; explains monthly variances.
Marketing Lead (Budget Owner)	Owns budget lines for content, SEO, social media, email marketing and paid advertising. Sets and monitors campaign spend caps; reports marketing ROI, cost per lead and customer acquisition cost.
Finance Officer (or outsourced accountant)	Maintains the books, processes approved invoices and expense claims, prepares payments, issues customer invoices, chases receivables, performs reconciliations, prepares the monthly financial pack, and keeps the financial records.
Petty Cash Custodian	Holds the petty cash float, issues cash against approved vouchers, keeps the cash log, and requests replenishment. Must not be the person who reconciles petty cash.
All employees, interns and contractors	Request and spend only with approval, submit claims with receipts on time, protect company assets and credentials, declare conflicts of interest, and report suspected fraud.
External accountant / tax advisor	Advises on tax compliance, withholding tax, sales tax on services and statutory filings; reviews year-end accounts. Has view-level or limited access as set out in Section 3.

2.1 Responsibility summary (RACI)

R = Responsible (does the work) · A = Accountable (final approval) · C = Consulted · I = Informed

Activity	Directors	Budget Owners	Finance Officer	All Staff
Annual budget	A	R	C	I
Expense claims	A (for Budget Owners)	A	R	R
Purchase requests	A (above limit)	A (within limit)	C	R
Petty cash	I	C	A	R (custodian)
Vendor payments	A	C	R	I
Customer invoicing and collections	I	C	R	I
Bank and account reconciliations	A	I	R	–
Monthly financial pack	A	C	R	I
Fraud reporting and investigation	A	C	C	R (report)

SECTION 03

Financial Access Permissions and Segregation of Duties

3.1 Access principles

- **Least privilege.** Each person receives only the access needed to do their role, and no more.
- **No shared logins.** Every user has a personal account with multi-factor authentication (MFA) enabled on the bank portal, accounting software, payroll system, ad platforms and document storage.
- **Written authorisation.** New access, changes and removals are requested in writing, approved by a Director, and logged in the access register.
- **Joiners, movers and leavers.** Access is granted on the start date, adjusted on any change of role, and removed on or before the last working day. Bank signatory and card changes are completed by a Director.
- **Quarterly access review.** A Director reviews who has access to what, removes anything unnecessary and records the review date and outcome.

3.2 Access permissions matrix

A = Approve / administer · P = Prepare / enter · V = View only · – = No access

System or function	Directors	Finance Officer	Budget Owners	Other staff	External accountant
Bank portal: view balances and statements	V	V	–	–	V
Bank portal: create payment batch	–	P	–	–	–
Bank portal: approve and release payment	A	–	–	–	–
Accounting software: enter bills and receipts	V	P	–	–	P
Accounting software: post journals and lock periods	A	P	–	–	P
Vendor master file: create or change vendors	A	P	–	–	–
Customer invoices: create and send	A	P	V	–	V
Payroll data and payments	A	P	–	–	V
Corporate card and ad-platform billing	A	V	P (own area)	–	–
Petty cash box	–	V	–	Custodian only	–
Finance document storage	A	P	V (own area)	–	V

3.3 Segregation of duties

The following duties must not be performed by the same person for the same transaction. Where the team is too small to separate a pair of duties, the compensating control in the right-hand column is mandatory.

Incompatible duties	Compensating control if one person must do both
Requesting a purchase and approving it	A different Budget Owner or a Director approves; no self-approval.
Creating a vendor and approving its invoices	Director reviews each new vendor and the vendor-change report monthly.
Approving an invoice and releasing the payment	Dual authorisation in the bank portal for payments above PKR 100,000; Director releases all payments.
Preparing the bank reconciliation and having bank access to pay	Reconciliation is reviewed and signed by a Director who did not prepare it.
Holding petty cash and reconciling it	Finance Officer or Director performs the cash count.
Issuing customer invoices and collecting cash or cheques	Receipts go directly to the bank account; any cash or cheque is banked within 1 working day.

Mandatory leave and rotation

Anyone who prepares payments or records transactions must take at least five consecutive working days of leave each year, during which their duties are covered by another person. Irregularities often surface when a regular processor is absent.

SECTION 04

Approval Authority Matrix

The matrix below sets the minimum approval needed to commit company money. The value is the **total commitment** (including taxes and, for contracts and subscriptions, the full contract value or 12 months of fees, whichever is greater). Splitting a purchase into smaller parts to avoid a limit is prohibited and is treated as a policy breach.

Total value (PKR)	Approval required	Supporting requirement
Up to 10,000	Budget Owner	Receipt or invoice. Must be within the approved budget line.
10,001 – 50,000	Budget Owner and Finance Officer budget check	Written purchase request; one quote or price evidence.
50,001 – 250,000	Budget Owner and a Director	Purchase request; two written quotes; purchase order.
250,001 – 1,000,000	Both Directors	Purchase request; three quotes or written sole-source justification; written agreement.
Above 1,000,000	Both Directors by written resolution	Business case, comparison of options, legal/tax review of the contract where relevant.

4.1 Rules that always apply

- **No self-approval.** A person never approves their own expense, purchase, payment or reimbursement. Budget Owners' own expenses are approved by a Director; a Director's expenses are approved by the other Director.
- **Within budget.** Approval is valid only if the spend fits the approved budget line. Unbudgeted spend above PKR 10,000 requires a Director's approval even if it falls under a lower limit above.
- **Approval is in writing** (signature on the form, or approval by email or workflow tool that is saved with the record). Verbal approvals are not accepted.
- **Payment authorisation.** Bank transfers are prepared by the Finance Officer and released by a Director. Transfers above PKR 100,000 need two authorisers.
- **Contracts and legal commitments** may be signed only by a Director.
- **Delegation.** When an approver is absent, the other Director (not a subordinate) approves. Temporary delegation is recorded in writing with start and end dates.

SECTION 05

Budget Preparation and Control

5.1 Budget structure

The Annual Budget translates the Sales and Marketing Plan and the company's service plan into financial targets. It contains a revenue forecast, a cost budget by category and owner, a monthly cash-flow forecast, and a target for marketing ROI. Each cost line has one named Budget Owner.

Budget category	Typical lines	Budget Owner
Revenue	Advisory retainers, project fees, workshops and training, other income	Directors
Marketing and lead generation	Paid advertising, SEO and content production, social media, email platform, events, design and video	Marketing Lead
Sales and customer retention	CRM, proposals software, client meetings and travel, client appreciation, referral incentives	Strategy Lead
People	Salaries, contractor fees, internship stipends, training, recruitment	Directors
Technology and tools	Software subscriptions, analytics, cloud storage, domains and hosting, equipment	Strategy Lead / Marketing Lead
Operations and administration	Rent and utilities, internet, insurance, professional fees (accounting, legal), bank charges, petty cash	Directors / Finance Officer
Taxes and statutory	Income tax, sales tax on services, withholding taxes, registrations and filings	Finance Officer
Contingency	Held by the Directors; not released without a Director's written approval	Directors

5.2 Annual budget cycle

Step	Action	Responsible	Timing
1	Review last year's actuals, the Sales and Marketing Plan targets (leads, conversion rate, revenue, CAC) and any planned hires or investments.	Directors, Budget Owners	8 weeks before year start
2	Budget Owners submit line-by-line proposals with a rationale, linking marketing spend to expected leads and revenue.	Budget Owners	6 weeks before
3	Consolidate, test against the cash-flow forecast, challenge assumptions, and identify funding gaps.	Finance Officer	5 weeks before
4	Review and approve the budget; set the contingency and the quarterly spending release schedule.	Both Directors	3 weeks before
5	Communicate approved budget to Budget Owners; load into accounting software for tracking.	Finance Officer	1 week before
6	Quarterly re-forecast against actual performance; approved changes are recorded as budget versions.	Directors, Budget Owners	Every quarter

5.3 Budget monitoring and variances

- Budget versus actual is reviewed **monthly** in the financial pack (Section 12).
- A variance of **more than 10% or PKR 25,000** on a budget line (whichever is lower) must be explained in writing by the Budget Owner, with an action plan.
- Budget Owners must not commit to spend beyond their line. Overspend requires a documented budget transfer approved by a Director *before* the commitment is made.
- Transfers between budget lines are permitted with Director approval; transfers out of Contingency need both Directors.
- If cash runway falls below **three months** of forecast operating costs, discretionary spend is frozen until the Directors review the position.

SECTION 06

Expense Approvals and Reimbursement

6.1 Eligible and ineligible expenses

Generally eligible (if approved and within budget)	Not eligible
Client meeting travel, local transport and parking Business meals with clients or while travelling on approved business Software, tools and subscriptions approved through a purchase request Courses and certifications approved in advance Printing, stationery and courier Phone or internet costs where agreed in writing	Personal purchases, family or personal travel Fines, penalties and traffic violations Alcohol, gambling or entertainment not connected to business Gifts in cash or cash equivalents Expenses with no receipt (unless exempted under 6.4) Expenses already reimbursed by a client or another source

6.2 Expense claim procedure

Step	Action	Responsible	Timing
1	Obtain **pre-approval** for travel, accommodation, training and any single expense above PKR 10,000.	Claimant, Budget Owner	Before spending
2	Pay using a company card where possible. If paying personally, keep the original receipt or tax invoice.	Claimant	At purchase
3	Complete the Expense Claim Form (Appendix B) with date, purpose, project or client code, budget line and amount; attach receipts.	Claimant	Within 14 days
4	Review for business purpose, policy compliance and budget availability; approve or return with reasons.	Budget Owner (Director for Budget Owners)	Within 3 working days
5	Check receipts, arithmetic, duplicates and coding; record the expense.	Finance Officer	Within 2 working days
6	Include approved claims in the next weekly payment run; pay by bank transfer to the claimant’s account.	Finance Officer, Director	Next payment run

6.3 Specific rules

- **Late claims.** Claims submitted more than 30 days after the expense date need Director approval. Claims older than 90 days may be declined.
- **Travel.** Book the most economical reasonable option. Overnight stays, flights and intercity travel need advance approval. Mileage or fuel is reimbursed at the rate set by the Directors.
- **Meals and hospitality.** State who attended and the business purpose. Client hospitality should be reasonable and consistent with the client’s own gift rules.
- **Company cards.** Cards are issued by a Director, are used only for business spending, and are reconciled monthly. Each card has a spending limit. Loss or suspected misuse is reported the same day.
- **Advances.** Travel or event advances above PKR 10,000 need Director approval and must be settled within 7 days of the trip or event; unsettled advances are deducted from the next payment due to the person.

6.4 Lost receipts

A missing receipt for an expense up to PKR 2,000 may be accepted once per person per quarter with a signed statement of the date, vendor, amount and purpose. Repeated or higher-value lost receipts need Director approval and may not be reimbursed.

SECTION 07

Purchase Requests and Procurement

7.1 When a purchase request is required

A Purchase Request (Appendix A) is required for any purchase above PKR 10,000, any new subscription or contract regardless of value, any purchase from a new vendor, and any commitment that recurs. Small, one-off purchases of PKR 10,000 or less within budget may be made with Budget Owner approval and a receipt.

7.2 Quotation requirements

Value (PKR)	Minimum quotations	Documents required
Up to 50,000	One quote or price evidence	Purchase request; invoice
50,001 – 250,000	Two written quotes	Purchase request; quotes; purchase order; invoice
Above 250,000	Three written quotes, or written sole-source justification	Purchase request; quote comparison; written agreement; purchase order; invoice

Selection is based on value for money (quality, fit, delivery, total cost and risk), not on price alone. The reason for the choice is recorded on the request. Quotes cannot be requested from, or awarded to, a person with an undeclared conflict of interest (Section 15).

7.3 Purchase request procedure

Step	Action	Responsible
1	Requester completes the Purchase Request, attaches quotes and states the budget line and business reason.	Requester
2	Finance Officer confirms budget availability and that the vendor is on the approved vendor list or can be onboarded.	Finance Officer
3	Approval per the Authority Matrix (Section 4). Requests are approved or declined in writing.	Approver
4	Finance Officer issues a numbered Purchase Order (PO) for purchases above PKR 50,000 and tells the vendor to quote the PO number on the invoice.	Finance Officer
5	Goods or services are received and confirmed as satisfactory by the requester (delivery note, completed work, access granted).	Requester
6	Invoice is matched to the request, PO and confirmation, then processed for payment (Section 9).	Finance Officer

7.4 Software and subscription register

The Finance Officer maintains a register of every recurring subscription (software, domains, hosting, advertising tools). For each, the register records the owner, purpose, billing cycle, renewal date, cost, payment method and the user list. Budget Owners review it quarterly and cancel unused tools. Free trials that require a company card must be approved first and cancelled or approved for continuation before the trial ends.

7.5 Marketing and advertising spend controls

Digital marketing (paid ads, social media promotion, email platforms, SEO tools, sponsored content) creates a high-volume, high-speed spending risk because spend can accumulate automatically. The following controls apply:

- **Approved campaign budget.** Every paid campaign has a written brief stating objective, audience, channel, duration, total budget and target cost per lead. The Marketing Lead approves campaigns within the monthly marketing budget; a Director approves anything beyond it.
- **Platform spending caps.** Daily and lifetime budget caps are set on every ad platform and may not exceed the approved campaign budget. Billing thresholds on ad accounts are set to prevent unexpected charges.
- **Ownership of ad accounts.** Ad, analytics, social and email-platform accounts are registered in the company's name with a company email, never in an individual's personal account. A Director holds administrator rights and the recovery details.
- **Weekly spend check.** The Marketing Lead compares platform spend with the approved plan each week. A campaign exceeding its budget by more than 10% is paused until the overspend is explained and approved.
- **Monthly reconciliation.** The Finance Officer reconciles each platform's invoices and card charges to the ledger (Section 13) and to the campaign report.
- **Agencies, freelancers and influencers.** Engaged under written scope, deliverables, fees and payment terms; paid against delivered work and invoice, not in advance, unless a Director approves a deposit.
- **Client-funded media.** When a client's advertising budget is spent through our accounts or cards, the funds are received in advance, recorded separately from company revenue, spent only as the client has approved, and reported to the client with platform statements.

SECTION 08

Petty Cash Management

Petty cash is used only for small, urgent, low-value business costs that cannot reasonably be paid by bank transfer or card. It carries a high risk of loss and misuse, so it is kept small and tightly controlled.

8.1 Petty cash parameters

Item	Control
Float (imprest) amount	PKR 20,000, set by the Directors. Changes need Director approval.
Maximum per transaction	PKR 5,000. Larger amounts follow the purchase or expense process.
Custodian	One named Petty Cash Custodian, appointed in writing by a Director, with a named deputy for absence.
Storage	Locked cash box in a locked cabinet; the key is held by the custodian only. Never mixed with personal money; never taken home.
Prohibited uses	Salary advances, loans, personal cheques cashed, payments to Directors or the custodian, payments split to avoid the per-transaction limit, and purchases that should be authorised under Section 7.
Replenishment trigger	When the cash falls below 25% of the float, or at month-end, whichever is sooner.

8.2 Petty cash procedure

Step	Action	Responsible
1	Requester completes a numbered Petty Cash Voucher (Appendix C) stating purpose and amount, and has it approved by the Budget Owner.	Requester, Budget Owner
2	Custodian checks the voucher is approved, within limits and consistent with policy; issues the cash and records it in the petty cash log.	Custodian
3	Requester returns the original receipt and any change within **2 working days**. Unsupported amounts are recovered from the requester.	Requester
4	Custodian files vouchers in numerical order, keeps the running balance, and ensures cash plus vouchers equals the float at all times.	Custodian
5	Custodian submits the vouchers and log to the Finance Officer for a replenishment request; the Finance Officer reviews, records the expenses and arranges a transfer or cheque for the exact amount spent.	Custodian, Finance Officer
6	Cash is counted **weekly** by the custodian and by someone else (Finance Officer or Director) at least monthly. A Director performs an unannounced count at least quarterly.	Custodian, Finance Officer, Director

8.3 Differences and losses

Any difference between the cash count and the expected balance is reported to the Finance Officer on the same day. Differences above PKR 500, or repeated small differences, are investigated by a Director. Losses caused by negligence or breach of this procedure may be recovered from the person responsible. Theft is reported under Section 14.

SECTION 09

Vendor Management and Payments

9.1 Vendor onboarding

A vendor may be paid only after it is set up on the approved vendor list. Vendor set-up is performed by the Finance Officer and approved by a Director using the Vendor Onboarding Checklist (Appendix D). The checklist covers:

- legal name, business registration or CNIC for sole proprietors, address and contact details;
- National Tax Number (NTN), tax registration status and any applicable sales tax registration for services;
- bank account name, number and branch, verified against a cancelled cheque, bank letter or official invoice (never an email alone);
- signed agreement or accepted terms, payment terms and confirmation of services or products supplied;
- a conflict-of-interest check: is the vendor connected to any employee or Director? (Section 15);
- for higher-risk vendors (those handling data, advertising accounts or client information), confirmation of confidentiality and data-protection commitments.

9.2 Changes to vendor bank details

High-risk change: always verify by call-back

Fraudsters often impersonate a vendor and ask to “update” bank details. Any change to a vendor’s bank account must be confirmed by calling the vendor on a **previously verified phone number** (not a number in the change request), documented on the vendor change form, and approved by a Director. Payments to the new account are held until this is complete. The Finance Officer prepares a monthly report of all vendor changes for Director review.

9.3 Invoice processing

Step	Action	Responsible
1	Invoices are received by the finance mailbox or portal only, logged on arrival with a unique reference, and filed with the request or PO.	Finance Officer
2	Validate: correct company name; vendor is on the approved list; valid tax invoice; invoice number unique (check for duplicates); arithmetic and tax correct; bank details match the vendor record.	Finance Officer
3	Three-way match: invoice agrees to the approved request or PO **and** to confirmation that the goods or services were received.	Finance Officer, Requester
4	Code the invoice to the budget line and project or client code; calculate any withholding tax to be deducted at source and any sales tax on services.	Finance Officer
5	Approve for payment per the Authority Matrix.	Budget Owner / Director
6	Schedule in the next payment run based on due date.	Finance Officer

9.4 Payment runs and release

- **Standard payment terms are 30 days** from receipt of a valid invoice unless the contract says otherwise. Payments are made in a **weekly payment run** (for example, Thursdays) to keep the process predictable.
- The Finance Officer prepares the batch with a payment listing and supporting documents; a Director reviews the listing against approved invoices and releases it in the bank portal. Payments above PKR 100,000 need two authorisers.
- Payments are made by bank transfer or crossed cheque to the verified account in the vendor’s name. Payments to personal accounts, third parties or cash are not allowed, except small items through petty cash.
- Withholding taxes deducted from vendor payments are deposited with the tax authority by the statutory due date and evidence is filed. The Finance Officer confirms current rates and requirements with the tax advisor.
- Urgent or off-cycle payments need a Director’s written approval stating the reason. Advance payments and deposits above PKR 50,000 need a Director’s approval and, where possible, a written agreement.
- Duplicate payments, overpayments and credit notes are recorded and recovered or offset promptly; the vendor statement is reconciled quarterly for key vendors.

9.5 Payroll and contractor payments

Payroll is prepared from approved employment contracts and attendance or timesheet records, reviewed by a Director before release, and paid by bank transfer. Changes to salary, bank details or new starters are requested in writing, approved by a Director and verified directly with the employee. Contractor fees are paid against an invoice or agreed milestone and the applicable tax deductions are made. A payroll reconciliation is performed monthly (Section 13).

SECTION 10

Customer Invoicing and Collections

Reliable collections turn the Sales and Marketing Plan's wins into cash. The sales process (lead generation, follow-up, conversion and customer retention) hands over to this process at the point a proposal is accepted.

10.1 Invoicing

- Invoices are issued only against a signed agreement, accepted proposal or approved purchase order, and are prepared by the Finance Officer, not by the person who sold the work.
- Recommended payment structure for projects: **an upfront deposit on signing**, milestone payments during the work, and a final payment on delivery. Retainers are invoiced **in advance** each month. Directors may approve different terms in writing.
- Invoices are issued within 2 working days of the trigger event (signing, milestone or month start), show the agreed scope, amounts, applicable sales tax on services, due date and bank details, and are numbered sequentially with no gaps.
- Corrections are made by credit note and re-issue, never by altering an issued invoice. Credit notes, discounts and refunds need approval by a Director.
- Customer payments are received by bank transfer into the company account. Cash and cheques are banked within 1 working day and a receipt is issued.

10.2 Collections and follow-up schedule

Timing	Action	Responsible
3 days before due date	Friendly reminder with invoice copy and payment details.	Finance Officer
Due date	Confirm receipt or send due-date notice.	Finance Officer
7 days overdue	Email and phone call to the customer's accounts contact; record the response.	Finance Officer
14 days overdue	Account owner (Strategy Lead) contacts the customer decision-maker; payment plan considered.	Strategy Lead
30 days overdue	Formal reminder; pause new work or deliverables as permitted by the agreement; Director informed.	Director
60 days overdue	Director decides on escalation, legal notice or write-off.	Directors

Overdue balances are reported monthly in an accounts receivable ageing report. Bad debts are written off only with both Directors' approval after documented collection efforts. Customer credit risk is considered before large engagements, and deposits are required for new customers where appropriate.

SECTION 11

Financial Recordkeeping

11.1 Books and records

- Accounts are kept in the company's accounting software using a chart of accounts approved by the Directors, with transactions recorded in the right period and coded to a budget line and, where relevant, a client project or marketing campaign.
- Every entry is supported by a document. Manual journals need a written explanation and Director approval.
- Closed accounting periods are locked. Changes to a locked period need Director approval and are recorded.
- A fixed assets register is kept for equipment above PKR 50,000, with a tag number, location and custodian; an annual physical check is performed.
- Client money and the company's own money are kept strictly separate.

11.2 Filing and naming

Records are stored in a restricted cloud folder, organised by financial year, month and category (bank, vendors, customers, expenses, payroll, tax, contracts). Files are named **YYYY-MM-DD_Counterparty_DocumentType_Amount**, for example *2026-10-19_VendorName_Invoice_45000*. Paper originals are scanned, and the scan is the working record. Folders are backed up and access is limited per Section 3.

11.3 Retention

Record type	Minimum retention
Books of account, ledgers, financial statements, tax returns and supporting documents	At least 6 years from the end of the relevant tax year; up to 10 years where company law requires it
Contracts and client agreements	Duration of contract plus 6 years
Payroll and employment financial records	6 years after the employee leaves
Bank statements, reconciliations and petty cash records	6 years
Quotes, requests and approvals	Same as the related transaction

The periods above are internal minimums. The Finance Officer confirms the legal requirements with the tax advisor annually. Records are not destroyed without a Director's approval, and anything related to a dispute, audit or investigation is kept until it is closed.

SECTION 12

Financial Reporting

12.1 Monthly management pack

By the **10th working day** of each month, the Finance Officer issues a management pack to the Directors and Budget Owners. It contains:

Report	What it shows	Used for
Income statement (profit and loss)	Revenue and costs for the month and year to date, with prior-year or budget comparison	Profitability and trend
Balance sheet	Assets, liabilities and equity; cash, receivables, payables, tax balances	Financial position
Cash-flow statement and forecast	Cash in and out, closing balance, forecast for the next 3 months and runway	Liquidity decisions
Budget versus actual	Variances by budget line with commentary from Budget Owners	Budget control
Accounts receivable and payable ageing	Overdue customer balances and vendor liabilities by age	Collections and payment planning
Marketing and sales performance	Spend by channel; leads; conversion rate; revenue won; customer acquisition cost; marketing ROI	Linking spend to results
Exceptions report	Policy exceptions, retrospective approvals, large or unusual transactions, vendor changes, unreconciled items	Control assurance

12.2 Key financial indicators

Indicator	How it is calculated	Why it matters
Gross margin	(Revenue − direct delivery costs) ÷ Revenue	Profitability of services
Cost per lead (CPL)	Marketing spend ÷ number of leads	Efficiency of lead generation
Customer acquisition cost (CAC)	Total sales and marketing cost ÷ new customers won	Cost of winning a customer
Marketing ROI	(Revenue attributable to marketing − marketing cost) ÷ marketing cost	Return on marketing investment
Days sales outstanding (DSO)	Average receivables ÷ revenue × days in period	Speed of collection
Cash runway	Cash balance ÷ average monthly net cash outflow	How long the business can operate
Budget variance	(Actual − Budget) ÷ Budget	Spending discipline

12.3 Periodic reporting

- **Quarterly:** a performance and budget review meeting, re-forecast, access review and a review of the vendor, subscription and conflict-of-interest registers.
- **Annually:** year-end accounts reviewed by the external accountant; tax returns and statutory filings submitted by their due dates; the Annual Budget and this SOP reviewed.
- **Reporting accuracy.** Management reports must be reconciled to the ledger. Figures are never adjusted to present a better position, and any estimate is labelled as one.

SECTION 13

Monthly Financial Review and Reconciliation

13.1 Month-end close calendar

The close is run to a fixed calendar so the numbers are timely and reviewed by someone other than the preparer. WD = working day after month-end.

Day	Close activity	Responsible
WD 1	Cut-off: confirm all invoices, claims and receipts are in; download bank, card and platform statements.	Finance Officer
WD 2	Record expense claims, petty cash replenishment and company card transactions.	Finance Officer
WD 3	Bank and card reconciliations; investigate unmatched items.	Finance Officer
WD 4	Accounts payable and receivable reconciled to ledger; accruals and prepayments posted.	Finance Officer
WD 5	Payroll, withholding tax and sales tax balances reconciled; ad-platform spend reconciled to ledger.	Finance Officer, Marketing Lead
WD 6	Draft financial statements and budget-versus-actual produced.	Finance Officer
WD 7	Variance review meetings with Budget Owners; written explanations obtained.	Budget Owners
WD 8	Director review of statements, reconciliations, exceptions and the vendor change report.	Directors
WD 9	Adjustments posted; reconciliations and close checklist signed off.	Finance Officer, Director
WD 10	Management pack issued; accounting period locked.	Finance Officer

13.2 Reconciliation responsibilities

Reconciliation	Prepared by	Reviewed by	Frequency
Bank accounts to the ledger	Finance Officer	Director	Monthly (cash position checked weekly)
Corporate cards	Finance Officer	Card holder and Director	Monthly
Ad platforms and subscriptions to ledger and campaign reports	Finance Officer	Marketing Lead and Director	Monthly
Petty cash	Custodian	Finance Officer	Weekly count; monthly reconciliation

Reconciliation	Prepared by	Reviewed by	Frequency
Accounts receivable to customer statements	Finance Officer	Strategy Lead	Monthly
Accounts payable to vendor statements (key vendors)	Finance Officer	Director	Monthly / quarterly
Payroll to approved payroll register and bank	Finance Officer	Director	Monthly
Tax accounts (withholding, sales tax on services, income tax)	Finance Officer	External tax advisor	Monthly / by filing date
Fixed assets register to physical check	Finance Officer	Director	Annually

13.3 Standards for reconciliation

- Each reconciliation is signed and dated by the preparer and the reviewer, with the supporting statement attached.
- **Unreconciled items** are listed with description, amount, owner and expected resolution date. Items above PKR 5,000 or older than 30 days are investigated; items older than 60 days are escalated to a Director.
- A reviewer must not be the person who prepared the reconciliation or who can release payments from the same account without another check.
- Any unexplained difference, missing document or evidence of manipulation is reported as an exception immediately, not carried forward.

SECTION 14

Fraud Prevention and Reporting

Fraud is any deliberate act of deception to gain a benefit or cause a loss, including theft, false claims, kickbacks and misuse of company assets or data. LaunchPoint Growth has a **zero-tolerance approach** to fraud and corruption.

14.1 Common fraud risks

Risk	Example	Key controls
Fictitious or duplicate vendor	A made-up supplier is paid; the same invoice is paid twice	Vendor onboarding approval; duplicate-invoice checks; monthly vendor change report
Bank-detail change fraud	Email asks to update a supplier’s account	Call-back to a verified number; Director approval; payment hold
Expense padding	Inflated, duplicate or personal claims	Receipts required; approver review; spot checks
Petty cash theft	Cash taken or vouchers falsified	Float limit; weekly counts; surprise audits; separated custodian
Misuse of ad budgets or cards	Personal spend on company cards; campaigns run for personal gain	Spend caps; company-owned ad accounts; monthly reconciliation
Payroll fraud	Ghost employee; unauthorised pay change	Director-approved changes; payroll reconciliation; direct verification
Kickbacks and bribery	Vendor rewards staff for winning orders	Competitive quotes; conflict declarations; gift rules

Risk	Example	Key controls
Revenue diversion	Client payment sent to a personal account; unrecorded sales	Invoices show company bank only; receipts reconciled to invoices
Cyber-enabled fraud	Phishing, spoofed Director emails requesting urgent payments	MFA; payment authorisation in portal only; staff awareness

14.2 Preventive controls

- Approvals, segregation of duties and access restrictions as set out in Sections 3 and 4.
- Dual authorisation for larger payments, call-back verification for bank-detail changes and no payments on the basis of an email or chat instruction alone, even if it appears to come from a Director.
- Reconciliations, exception reports and Director review each month.
- Surprise checks: petty cash counts, expense claim sampling and vendor verification.
- Annual fraud-awareness briefing for everyone who handles money, and a refresh when new risks appear.
- Background and reference checks for finance roles, to the extent permitted by law.

14.3 Warning signs

Treat the following as red flags and report them promptly:

- Pressure to pay urgently or to bypass normal approval; requests for secrecy.
- Missing, altered or photocopied receipts; invoices without a PO or from unfamiliar vendors.
- A vendor or person with unexplained links to an employee; round-number invoices just under approval limits.
- Reluctance to take leave or to let others see records; reconciling items that keep growing.
- Lifestyle that does not match known income; sudden changes in behaviour around financial duties.

14.4 Reporting and investigation

Step	Action
Report	Report suspected fraud or policy breaches immediately to a Director. If the concern involves a Director, report to the other Director or the external advisor. Reports can be made in writing or by a confidential channel designated by the Directors.
Protect	Secure the records and access at risk; suspend access or payments if needed. Do not alert the person concerned.
Investigate	A Director (or an independent person) investigates fairly, keeps notes and evidence, and limits information to those who need to know.
Decide	The Directors decide on disciplinary action, recovery of losses, notification of the bank, insurer or authorities, and legal advice.
Learn	Control weaknesses are corrected, and the outcome is recorded in the exceptions log.

Non-retaliation

No one will be penalised for reporting a concern in good faith. Retaliation against a person who raises a concern is itself a serious breach of this SOP. Knowingly making a false report is also a breach.

SECTION 15

Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest exists when a personal interest, relationship or outside activity could influence, or appear to influence, a person's judgement on behalf of LaunchPoint Growth. Having a conflict is not wrongdoing in itself; **failing to declare and manage it is**.

15.1 Examples

- A vendor, contractor or agency is owned by, employs or is closely related to an employee, a Director or their family or close friends.
- Awarding or influencing a purchase, hire or payment involving a relative or a business in which the person holds a financial interest.
- Outside employment, consulting or board roles with a competitor, vendor or client.
- Accepting gifts, hospitality, discounts or favours from vendors, clients or prospects.
- Advising two clients with directly competing interests without disclosing it and obtaining their consent.
- Using company information, time or resources for personal business.

15.2 Declaration and management procedure

Step	Requirement
Declare	Everyone who approves or influences spending signs a Conflict of Interest Declaration (Appendix E) on joining, annually, and **whenever a new conflict arises**.
Record	A Director maintains the Conflicts Register: person, interest, date, decision and review date.
Decide	A Director (the other Director if the conflict concerns a Director) decides the management action: no action, additional oversight or full recusal.
Recuse	A conflicted person does not select, approve, negotiate or pay the related vendor, and does not take part in the decision.
Related-party transactions	Transactions with a Director, employee or their relatives or businesses need approval from the other Director(s), written terms at arm's length and reporting in the financial statements as required.
Review	The register is reviewed each quarter and annually with the declarations.

15.3 Gifts and hospitality

Situation	Rule
Cash or cash equivalents (vouchers, transfers)	Never accept or give.
Gifts or hospitality up to PKR 5,000, occasional and customary	May be accepted if not linked to a pending decision; declare to your Budget Owner.
Gifts or hospitality above PKR 5,000	Declare in writing to a Director before accepting; normally declined or shared with the whole team.
During a tender or negotiation	Do not accept any gifts or hospitality from bidders or counterparties.

Situation	Rule
Giving gifts to clients or prospects	Must be modest, approved by a Budget Owner, recorded as an expense and permitted by the recipient's own rules. Never offered to influence a decision.

SECTION 16

Exceptions, Breaches and Policy Review

16.1 Exceptions

Genuine emergencies may require an approval step to be skipped. In such a case the person must (a) obtain verbal confirmation from a Director where possible, (b) document the reason and amount, and (c) submit the request for retrospective approval within **3 working days**. Exceptions are listed in the monthly exceptions report. Repeated exceptions by the same person or team are reviewed by the Directors.

16.2 Breaches of this SOP

Failure to follow this SOP, including splitting purchases, committing spend without approval, falsifying documents or concealing a conflict, may lead to disciplinary action up to and including termination, recovery of funds, and referral to the authorities where the law is broken. The severity of the action reflects the intent, the amount and whether the matter was reported honestly.

16.3 Review and amendment

- The Directors review this SOP at least **annually**, and sooner after a fraud incident, an audit finding, a major change in revenue or headcount, or a change in tax or other law.
- Changes are proposed by the Document Owner, approved by both Directors, recorded in the revision history and communicated to all staff, who confirm in writing that they have read and understood the update.
- New employees, interns and contractors who handle money receive an induction on this SOP before being given any financial responsibility.

APPENDIX A

Purchase Request Form

Request no.		**Date**	
Requester		**Department / role**	
Budget line		**Project / client code**	
Vendor name		**Vendor on approved list?**	Yes / No / Onboarding required

Description of goods or services	
Business reason	
Amount excluding tax (PKR)	
Tax (PKR)	
Total commitment (PKR)	
One-off or recurring?	One-off / Monthly / Annual (renewal date: _____)
Quotes attached	1 / 2 / 3 Sole-source justification attached: Yes / No
Reason for selected vendor	
Conflict of interest?	None known / Declared (details attached)

Approvals

Step	Name	Signature	Date	Decision
Budget Owner				Approve / Decline
Finance Officer (budget check)				Funds available: Yes / No
Director				Approve / Decline
Second Director (above PKR 250,000)				Approve / Decline

PO number issued: _____ Goods or service received (date and by): _____

APPENDIX B

Expense Claim Form

Claimant		**Claim period**	
Role		**Budget line**	
Bank account for reimbursement		**Claim date**	

Date	Description and business purpose	Client / project	Receipt no.	Amount (PKR)
	Total claimed			

Declaration: I confirm that these expenses were incurred wholly for company business, are supported by the attached receipts, and have not been claimed elsewhere.

Claimant signature / date		**Budget Owner approval / date**	
Finance Officer check / date		**Director approval / date (if required)**	
Date paid		**Payment reference**	

APPENDIX C

Petty Cash Voucher and Log

Petty cash voucher

Voucher no.		**Date**	
Paid to / requested by		**Amount (PKR)**	
Purpose		**Budget line**	
Approved by (Budget Owner)		**Receipt attached**	Yes / No (return within 2 working days)
Cash issued by (Custodian)		**Received by (signature)**	

Petty cash log

Date	Voucher no.	Description	Cash out	Cash in (replenish)	Balance
		Opening float: PKR 20,000			

Count date	Cash counted	Vouchers total	Difference	Counted by	Verified by

APPENDIX D

Vendor Onboarding Checklist

Vendor legal name		**Date**	
Type of service / product		**Requested by**	

Check	Evidence / notes	Done (initials)
Business registration or CNIC (sole proprietor) obtained		
NTN and tax registration status confirmed; sales tax registration for services where applicable		
Bank account details verified (cancelled cheque or bank letter); account name matches vendor		
Contract, scope of work or accepted terms signed; payment terms agreed		
Quotes or competitive process completed per Section 7.2		
Conflict-of-interest check completed; no undeclared relationship with staff or Directors		
Confidentiality and data-protection terms confirmed (if vendor handles client or company data)		
Vendor added to approved list by Finance Officer		
Director approval of new vendor		

APPENDIX E

Conflict of Interest Declaration

Complete this form when you join, once each year, and whenever your circumstances change. If in doubt, declare.

Name		**Role**	
Date		**Type of declaration**	Joining / Annual / New conflict

Question	Answer (tick) and details
Do you, or a close family member or friend, own, work for, or have a financial interest in any actual or potential vendor, contractor, client or competitor of LaunchPoint Growth?	No / Yes: _____
Do you hold any outside employment, consulting, board or business role?	No / Yes: _____
Have you received gifts or hospitality above PKR 5,000 in the last 12 months?	No / Yes: _____
Are you aware of any situation that may influence, or appear to influence, your decisions at work?	No / Yes: _____

I confirm that the information above is complete and accurate, and I will declare any change promptly.

Signature		**Date**	
Director decision / actions		**Review date**	

APPENDIX F

Monthly Close Sign-off Checklist

Month / year		Prepared by	

Close task	Prepared by	Reviewed by	Date	Done
All invoices, claims and receipts for the month received and recorded				
Bank accounts reconciled; unreconciled items listed and explained				
Corporate cards and ad platforms reconciled to ledger and campaign reports				
Petty cash counted and reconciled; vouchers filed				
Accounts receivable ageing reviewed; overdue follow-ups assigned				
Accounts payable reconciled; upcoming payment run reviewed				
Payroll and tax balances (withholding, sales tax) reconciled				
Accruals, prepayments and manual journals approved				
Vendor change report and subscription register reviewed				
Budget-versus-actual variances explained by Budget Owners				
Exceptions report completed				
Management pack issued and period locked				

Director sign-off: _____ Date: _____

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